

SUPERIOR COURT OF CALIFORNIA, CONTRA COSTA COUNTY
MARTINEZ, CA
DEPARTMENT 14, RICHMOND
JUDICIAL OFFICER: KIRK ATHANASIOU
HEARING DATE: 04/14/2026

For matters where an appearance is required, the parties should appear by Zoom unless told to appear by another method. For all other matters, if argument is requested appearances may be in person or by Zoom.

Please email Dept14@contracosta.courts.ca.gov and opposing counsel by 4:00 p.m. if oral argument is requested and include specification to be argued.

Zoom hearing information

<https://contracosta-courts-ca.zoomgov.com/j/16103009385?pwd=TjFZRDBnNkVQRIV0Znhvai9qT05tZz09#success>

Law & Motion

1. 9:00 AM CASE NUMBER: L24-04656
CASE NAME: AMERICAN EXPRESS NATIONAL BANK VS. BRIAN VONGTHAVADY
*HEARING ON MOTION IN RE: TO RELIEVED AS ATTY FOR DEF
FILED BY:

TENTATIVE RULING:

Counsel for Defendant filed a motion to be relieved as counsel. Defendant was notified by mail at an address for which he was served with process.

The Motion is unopposed by the Defendant.

Counsel declares that she has been unable to contact her client despite numerous attempts.

The court notes that there is a court trial scheduled for 6/3/26, but the Defendant should have ample

time to prepare or seek new counsel, or, at minimum, request a continuance to do so.

Disposition

Motion is granted.

Counsel for Defendant shall file the Order.

2. 9:00 AM CASE NUMBER: L24-06150
CASE NAME: JPMORGAN CHASE BANK, N.A. VS. KANJANA JANJOO
***HEARING ON MOTION IN RE: TO SET ASIDE JUDGMENT**
FILED BY: JPMORGAN CHASE BANK, N.A.

TENTATIVE RULING:

Plaintiff filed a Motion to Set Aside Judgment and dismissal without prejudice.

The Motion was served on an address for Defendant where substituted service occurred for service of process.

Either way, the court finds that there is no prejudice to Defendant in granting the Motion, so, even assuming that service of this Motion was not done properly, the court will dispense with notice requirements.

Disposition

Plaintiff's Motion is Granted.

The action is dismissed without prejudice.

Plaintiff to file Order.

3. 9:00 AM CASE NUMBER: L24-08676
CASE NAME: PORTFOLIO RECOVERY ASSOCIATES, LLC VS. MARGARET GICHIA
***HEARING ON MOTION IN RE: MOTION TO SET ASIDE DISMISSAL AND ENTER JUDGMENT UNDER**
STIP FILED BY PLN ON 1/13/26
FILED BY: PORTFOLIO RECOVERY ASSOCIATES, LLC

TENTATIVE RULING:

Background

Plaintiff filed a motion to vacate dismissal and enter judgment pursuant to stipulation. The Motion and its supporting documents are timely.

This Motion is unopposed.

Analysis

Mail service was completed at an address for the Defendant where she was personally